

Munich, 2025-06-30

Letter of reference

To whom it may concern,

This letter is to introduce Mr. Maximilian Giehl, born on [REDACTED], who worked as a Corporate Finance Intern in the Munich office of Stifel Europe Advisory GmbH from 15 April 2025 until 30 June 2025.

Stifel Europe Advisory GmbH, a subsidiary of Stifel Company (together "Stifel"), is a leading international corporate finance and financial advisory firm for mid-market clients and entrepreneurs in Europe and beyond. We offer our clients comprehensive corporate finance advisory services including M&A and capital markets advisory as well as restructuring, debt and strategic advisory.

During his time at our company, Mr. Giehl had the opportunity to gain thorough insights into the daily operations of an international corporate finance practice and to work on different buy-side, sell-side and capital raising processes. His engagements and assigned tasks were as follows:

Corporate Finance / M&A

- Preparation and analyses of company financials and capital markets data (by use of the following databases: Bloomberg, S&P Capital IQ, PitchBook and Mergermarket) as well as assistance in financial modeling
- Conduction of company valuations using best practice methodologies (CCA, CTA, DCF)
- Preparation of company presentations, pitch books and investment proposals in English and German
- Conduction of market and competitive analyses as well as industry screenings for the identification of potential acquisition targets / investors in the food and automotive industry
- Support in approaching potential investors in the course of sell side projects
- Support in preparation of virtual data rooms and Q&A processes

Mr. Giehl is a well-rounded person with excellent analytical skills, which played a key role for his convincing performance during his internship at Stifel. Thanks to his keen intellect, strong interest in financial markets and very well-structured way of working, Mr. Giehl performed all his duties and assignments in a timely manner, with a very high level of professionalism and always to our full satisfaction.

While quickly comprehending new concepts and applying those to assigned tasks, Mr. Giehl always showed a high level of commitment, flexibility and willingness to learn. His great motivation made him a very valuable team player who was highly appreciated by his superiors and colleagues.

We thank Mr. Giehl for his consistently great contribution to our company and we wish him continued success and the very best for his future career and private life.

Stifel Europe Advisory GmbH

A handwritten signature in blue ink, appearing to read 'T. Klack', is positioned above the printed name.

Thomas Klack
Managing Director